

Zijian (Longino) ZHAO 赵子健

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Education

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Clearwater Bay Campus, Hong Kong)

Sep. 2024 – Present

Ph.D. in Civil Engineering (Scientific Computation)

GPA: 3.8/4.2

Supervisor: Prof. Sen Li

Main Research Directions: Deep Learning, Reinforcement Learning, LLMs, Intelligent Transportation, Smart City, AI Ethics

Sun Yat-sen University (Guangzhou Campus)

Sep. 2020 – Jul. 2024

B.Eng. in Computer Science and Technology (National Basic Subject Talent Training Plan)

GPA: 4.0/5.0, Rank: Top 10%

Supervisors: Prof. Kai Huang, Prof. Chengying Gao, Prof. Ning Liu

Main Research Directions: Deep Learning, Domain Adaptation, Wireless Sensing, Music Information Retrieval, Robot Control

Thesis: Motion Control Method for Small Quadruped Robots Based on Trajectory Modulation and Reinforcement Learning

Ranking First in: Computer Programming, Principles of Compilers, Distributed Systems, Embedded Systems, Complex Variables, Mathematical Analysis, Advanced Algebra, Data Structures and Algorithms, Probability and Statistics, Discrete Mathematics

Experience

Research Intern

Apr. 2026 – Oct. 2026

Noah's Ark Lab, 2012 Laboratories, Huawei

Mentor: Xialiang Tong

Industry-Academia-Research Student

Feb. 2024 – Aug. 2024

Likelihood Lab, Guangzhou WenSight Intelligent Technology Co., Ltd.

Online, Part-time

Visiting Student

Aug. 2023 – Aug. 2024

Shenzhen Research Institute of Big Data, The Chinese University of Hong Kong (Shenzhen)

Supervisor: Prof. Guangxu Zhu

Research Interest

My research interests lie in sensing, prediction, and decision-making for smart cities and intelligent transportation systems, addressing problems such as order dispatch, algorithmic labor management, wireless sensing, and traffic prediction. On the technical side, I focus primarily on deep learning, multi-agent reinforcement learning, transfer learning, and large models. Overall, I am interested in and open to interdisciplinary AI, applied AI, and AI humanities.

Publications

*: Corresponding Author; ¹: Equal Contributions; [J/C/W/R/P]: Journal/Conference/Workshop/Report/Working Preprints

A. Selected Papers:

- [C1] **Zijian Zhao**, Sen Li*, "Triple-BERT: Do We Really Need MARL for Ride-Sharing Order Dispatch?", 2026 International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR), 2026 (CCF-A, **oral**) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [C2] **Zijian Zhao**, Dian Jin, Zijiang Zhou, Xiaoyu Zhang*, "Automatic Stage Lighting Control: Is it a Rule-Driven Process or a Generative Task?", 2026 International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR), 2026 (CCF-A) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)] [[Dataset](#)] [[Model](#)]
- [J1] **Zijian Zhao**, Sen Li*, "The Impacts of Data Privacy Regulations on Food-Delivery Platforms", Transportation Research Part C: Emerging Technologies (TR_C), 2025 (JCR-Q1) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [J2] **Zijian Zhao**, Sen Li*, "Discriminatory Order Assignment and Payment-Setting of On-Demand Food-Delivery Platforms: A Multi-Action and Multi-Agent Reinforcement Learning Framework", Transportation Research Part E: Logistics and Transportation Review (TR_E), 2025 (JCR-Q1, ABS-3) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [J3] **Zijian Zhao**, Fanyi Meng, Zhonghao Lyu, Hang Li, Xiaoyang Li, Guangxu Zhu*, "CSI-BERT2: A BERT-Inspired Framework for Efficient CSI Prediction and Recognition in Wireless Communication and Sensing", IEEE Transactions on Mobile Computing (TMC), 2025 (JCR-Q1, CCF-A) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)] [[Dataset](#)] [[Model](#)]
- [J4] **Zijian Zhao**, Zhijie Cai, Tingwei Chen, Xiaoyang Li, Hang Li, Qimei Chen, Guangxu Zhu*, "KNN-MMD: Cross Domain Wireless Sensing via Local Distribution Alignment", IEEE Transactions on Mobile Computing (TMC), 2025 (JCR-Q1, CCF-A) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)] [[Dataset](#)]
- [J5] **Zijian Zhao**, Tingwei Chen, Zhijie Cai, Xiaoyang Li, Hang Li, Qimei Chen, Guangxu Zhu*, "CrossFi: A Cross Domain Wi-Fi Sensing Framework Based on Siamese Network", IEEE Internet of Things Journal (IOT-J), 2025 (JCR-Q1, CCF-C) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)]

B. Other Papers:

- [C3] **Zijian Zhao**, “Towards Fairness in Transportation Gig Markets: Identifying, Imitating, and Mitigating Algorithm Discrimination via Deep Reinforcement Learning”, 2026 Annual AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI) / Special Interest Group on Artificial Intelligence (SIGAI) Doctoral Consortium, 2026 (CCF-A DC) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)] [[Interview](#)]
- [C4] **Zijian Zhao***, Dian Jin, Zijing Zhou, “Zero-Effort Image-to-Music Generation: An Interpretable RAG-Based VLM Approach”, 2026 ACM International Conference on Multimedia Retrieval (ICMR), 2026 (CCF-B short paper) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [C5] **Zijian Zhao**, Sen Li*, “Discriminatory Order Assignment and Payment Setting on Food-Delivery Platforms: The Implicit Algorithmic Biases”, 2026 INFORMS Transportation Science and Logistics Conference (TSL), 2026 [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [C6] **Zijian Zhao**, Jing Gao*, Sen Li, “Ride-Hailing Order Dispatching with A Mixture of On-Demand and Pre-Booked Requests via Reinforcement Learning”, 2026 COTA International Conference of Transportation Professionals (CICTP), 2026 [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [W1] Shiting Chen¹, **Zijian Zhao**¹, Jinsong Chen*, “Confident RAG: Enhancing the Performance of LLMs for Mathematics Question Answering through Multi-Embedding and Confidence Scoring”, 2026 International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) LLM Reasoning Workshop, 2026 (CCF-A workshop) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [C7] Chuxue Cao, Jinluan Yang, Haoran Li, Kunhao Pan, **Zijian Zhao**, Zhengyu Chen, Yuchen Tian, Lijun Wu, Conghui He, Sirui Han, Yike Guo, “Pushing the Boundaries of Natural Reasoning: Interleaved Bonus from Formal-Logic Verification”, 2026 International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML), 2026 (CCF-A) [[Paper](#)] [[Model](#)]
- [C8] **Zijian Zhao***, “Let Network Decide What to Learn: Symbolic Music Understanding Model Based on Large-Scale Adversarial Pre-Training”, 2025 ACM International Conference on Multimedia Retrieval (ICMR), 2025 (CCF-B short paper) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)] [[Model](#)]
- [W2] **Zijian Zhao**, Tingwei Chen, Fanyi Meng, Zhijie Cai, Hang Li, Xiaoyang Li, Guangxu Zhu*, “LoFi: Vision-Aided Label Generator for Wi-Fi Localization and Tracking Sensing”, 2025 IEEE Global Communications Conference (GLOBECOM) GenAI NGN Workshop, 2025 (CCF-C workshop) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)] [[Dataset](#)]
- [C9] **Zijian Zhao**, Zhijie Cai, Tingwei Chen, Xiaoyang Li, Hang Li, Qimei Chen, Guangxu Zhu*, “Does MMD Really Align? A Cross Domain Wireless Sensing Method via Local Distribution”, 2025 IEEE/CIC International Conference on Communications in China (ICCC), 2025 [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [C10] **Zijian Zhao**, Sen Li*, “Multi-Agent Reinforcement Learning for Order Assignment and Payment Setting on Food-Delivery Platforms: The Implicit Algorithmic Biases”, 2025 International Symposium on Transportation Data & Modeling (ISTDM), 2025 [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [J6] Haolong Chen, Hanzhi Chen, **Zijian Zhao**, Kaifeng Han*, Guangxu Zhu*, Yichen Zhao, Ying Du, Wei Xu, Qingjiang Shi, “An Overview of Domain-Specific Foundation Model: Key Technologies, Applications and Challenges”, Science China Information Sciences (SCIS), 2025 (JCR-Q1, CCF-A) [[Paper](#)]
- [W3] Tingwei Chen, Yantao Wang, Hanzhi Chen, **Zijian Zhao**, Xinhao Li, Nicola Piovesan, Guangxu Zhu*, Qingjiang Shi, “Modeling the 5G Energy Consumption using Real-World Data: Energy Fingerprint is All You Need”, 2025 IEEE Global Communications Conference (GLOBECOM) GenAI NGN Workshop, 2025 (CCF-C workshop) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [C11] Chuxue Cao, Mengze Li, Juntao Dai, Jinluan Yang, **Zijian Zhao**, Shengyu Zhang, Weijie Shi, Chengzhong Liu, Sirui Han, Yike Guo, “Towards Advanced Mathematical Reasoning for LLMs via First-Order Logic Theorem Proving”, 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2025 (CCF-B) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [W4] **Zijian Zhao**, Tingwei Chen, Fanyi Meng, Hang Li, Xiaoyang Li, Guangxu Zhu*, “Finding the Missing Data: A BERT-Inspired Approach Against Package Loss in Wireless Sensing”, 2024 IEEE International Conference on Computer Communications (INFOCOM) DeepWireless Workshop, 2024 (CCF-A workshop) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)] [[Dataset](#)] [[Model](#)]
- [C12] Xiao Liang (supervisor), **Zijian Zhao**, Weichao Zeng, Yutong He, Fupeng He, Yiyi Wang, Chengying Gao*, “PianoBART: Symbolic Piano Music Understanding and Generating with Large-Scale Pre-Training”, 2024 IEEE Conference on Multimedia Expo (ICME), 2024 (CCF-B, oral) [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)] [[Model](#)]
- [C13] Zitao Zhang, Yuhong Huang, **Zijian Zhao**, Zhenshan Bing, Chenglin Cai, Alois Knoll and Kai Huang*, “Autonomous Locomotion of a Rat Robot Based on Model-Free Reinforcement Learning”, 2024 IEEE International Conference on Advanced Robotics and Mechatronics (ICARM), 2024 [[Paper](#)]
- [C14] Zitao Zhang, Yuhong Huang, **Zijian Zhao**, Zhenshan Bing, Alois Knoll and Kai Huang*, “A Hierarchical Reinforcement Learning Approach for Adaptive Quadruped Locomotion of a Rat Robot”, 2023 IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Biomimetics (ROBIO), 2023 (**best paper finalist**) [[Paper](#)]
- [C15] Zitao Zhang*, Yuhong Huang, **Zijian Zhao**, Zhenshan Bing, Kai Huang, “Autonomous Locomotion of a Rat Robot Based on Reinforcement Learning”, 2023 CCF China Intelligent Robotics Annual Conference (CIRAC), 2023 [[Paper](#)]

C. Working Papers:

- [P1] **Zijian Zhao**, Sen Li*, “Beyond Multi-Agent Reinforcement Learning: Scalable Centralized Control for Large-Scale Dynamic Trip-Vehicle Assignment” (under second-round review, INFORMS Journal on Computing (IJOC))
- [P2] **Zijian Zhao**, Sen Li*, “OSPO: One-Step Policy Optimization for Real-Time Order Assignment on Ride-Sharing Platforms with Autonomous Vehicles” (under third-round review, Transportation Research Part C: Emerging Technologies (TR_C))
- [P3] **Zijian Zhao**, Jing Gao*, Sen Li, “Real-Time Order Assignment for Ride-Sharing Platforms with a Mixture of Pre-booked and On-Demand Requests” (under second-round review, Transportation Research Part C: Emerging Technologies (TR_C))
- [P4] **Zijian Zhao**, Sen Li*, “Discriminatory Labor Management for On-Demand Meal Delivery Platforms with a Mixed Fleet of AVs and Human Couriers” (under first-round review, Transportation Research Part C: Emerging Technologies (TR_C))

- [P5] Yang Liu¹, **Zijian Zhao**¹, Sen Li*, “Joint Infrastructure Planning and Order Assignment for On-Demand Food-Delivery Services with Coordinated Drones and Human Couriers” (under first-round review, Transportation Research Part C: Emerging Technologies (TR_C))
- [P6] **Zijian Zhao**, Sen Li*, “One Step is Enough: Multi-Agent Reinforcement Learning Based on One-Step Policy Optimization for Order Dispatch on Ride-Sharing Platforms” (under review, 2026 Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)) [[ArXiv](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [P7] **Zijian Zhao**, Jing Gao*, Sen Li, “Bridging MARL to SARL: An Order-Independent Multi-Agent Transformer via Latent Consensus” (under review, 2026 Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)) [[ArXiv](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [P8] **Zijian Zhao**, Yitong Shang, Sen Li*, “AutoFed: Personalized Federated Traffic Prediction via Adaptive Prompt” (under review, 2026 Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)) [[ArXiv](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [P9] **Zijian Zhao**, Dian Jin, Zijing Zhou, Xiaoyu Zhang*, “Stage Light is Sequence²: Multi-Light Control via Imitation Learning” (under review, 2026 Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)) [[ArXiv](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [P10] **Zijian Zhao**, Xialiang Tong, Sen Li*, “Optimizing Denoising Trajectories in DLLMs: A Lightweight Evolutionary Heuristic Approach” (in preparation, 2027 AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI))
- [P11] **Zijian Zhao**, Yulong Hu, Sen Li*, “RideGym: A Standardized Interface for Real-World Large-Scale Ride-Sharing System” (in preparation, 2027 ACM SIGKDD Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (KDD))
- [P12] **Zijian Zhao**, Yitong Shang, Sen Li*, “Personalized Federated Traffic Prediction via Prompt-Guided Global Representation and Node-Specific Adaptation” (in preparation)

D. Reports:

- [R1] **Zijian Zhao**, Xuming Zhang, Jiayu Wen, Mingwen Liu*, Xiaoteng Ma, “Label Unbalance in High-Frequency Trading”, 2025 (reported by [QuantML](#)) [[ArXiv](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [R2] **Zijian Zhao***, “A Short Overview of Multi-Modal Wi-Fi Sensing”, 2025 [[ArXiv](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [R3] Dian Jin*, **Zijian Zhao**, Zijing Zhou, “IfWorld: A Multi-Agent Framework for Cross-Disciplinary Counterfactual Scenario Reasoning”, 2025 [[PDF](#)] [[Code](#)]
- [R4] Tingwei Chen, Jiayi Chen, **Zijian Zhao**, Haolong Chen, Liang Zhang*, Guangxu Zhu*, “First Token Probability Guided RAG for Telecom Question Answering”, 2025 [[ArXiv](#)]
- [R5] **Zijian Zhao**, Zitao Zhang, Kai Huang*, “A Trajectory-Based Reinforcement Learning Approach for Autonomous Locomotion of a Rat Robot”, 2024 [[PDF](#)] [[Code](#)]

Patents

A. Granted Patents:

- [1] **Zijian Zhao**, Guangxu Zhu, Qimei Chen, Kaifeng Han, "Method for Object Recognition Using Model Based on Few-Shot Learning and Related Equipment", Chinese Patent, Patent Number: ZL202411074110, 2024 [[PDF](#)]
- [2] **Zijian Zhao**, Kaifeng Han, Qimei Chen, Guangxu Zhu, Xiaoyang Li, Hang Li, "Channel State Information Recovery Method and Apparatus, Equipment, Storage Medium", Chinese Patent, Patent Number: ZL2024102321250, 2024 [[PDF](#)]

B. Published Patents:

- [1] **Zijian Zhao**, Guangxu Zhu, Kaifeng Han, Xiaoyang Li, Hang Li, "Method for Classifying Data Using Model Based on Few-Shot Learning and Related Equipment", Chinese Patent, Application Number: 2024108392137, 2024 [[PDF](#)]
- [2] **Zijian Zhao**, Guangxu Zhu, Shen Chao, Shi Qingjiang, Han Kaifeng, "Personnel Detection Method, Device, Electronic Equipment, and Storage Medium", Chinese Patent, Application Number: 2024105419689, 2024 [[PDF](#)]
- [3] Kai Huang, Zitao Zhang, **Zijian Zhao**, Ruoyi Tao, "A Motion Control Method for Small Bionic Rat Based on Reinforcement Learning", Chinese Patent, Application Number: 2023116499786, 2023 [[PDF](#)]

Projects

A. Projects as Student Participant (PI: Supervisor):

- [1] "Development of a Dynamic Itinerary Planning and Traffic Prediction System for Tourist Coaches", Hong Kong Society for Transportation Studies & Hong Kong Tourism Association Limited & LimX Dynamics Project, 2024-2025 [[Code](#)]
- [2] "Indoor Human Activity Recognition Based on Wi-Fi", Shenzhen Research Institute of Big Data Project, 2023-2024 [[Code](#)]
- [3] "Spectrum Efficiency Modeling with Measured MIMO Channel", Huawei & Shenzhen Research Institute of Big Data Project, 2023-2024 [[Code](#)]

B. Projects as Principal Investigator (Self-Initiated):

- [1] "Piano Music Generation Based on BART", College Students' Innovation Training Program at Sun Yat-Sen University, 2023-2024 [[Paper](#)] [[Code](#)]

Main Awards & Grants

A. Awards:

- [1] The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology RedBird PhD Award, 2024 (also won scholarship in 2026)
- [2] Runner Up Prize (No.2 out of 776 teams) in AI/ML for 5G-Energy Consumption Modeling by ITU AI/ML in 5G Challenge, 2023
- [3] Third Prize (No.6 out of 287 teams) in The First Wi-Fi Sensing Contest by Huawei, 2023
- [4] Best Paper Award Finalist of Biomimetics in IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Biomimetics (ROBIO) 2023, 2023
- [5] Provincial Second Prize in SPSS University Contest in Modeling, 2022
- [6] Second Prize in Asia and Pacific Mathematical Contest in Modeling, 2022
- [7] First-Class Scholarship for Outstanding Student of Sun Yat-sen University, 2021 (also won scholarship in 2022, 2023)
- [8] Meritorious Winner in the Mathematical Contest in Modeling, 2021 (also won the award in 2022)
- [9] Provincial First Prize in the Chinese Mathematics Competitions, 2021
- [10] Second Prize & Provincial First Prize in the National High School Mathematics League, 2019

B. Grants:

- [1] Student Travel Awards by ACM SIGMM, 2026
- [2] Research Travel Grant by The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST), 2026
- [3] PhD Student Travel Fund by Hong Kong Society for Transportation Studies (HKSTS), 2026

Talks & Presentation

- [1] "Discriminatory Order Assignment and Payment-Setting of On-Demand Food-Delivery Platforms: The Impacts of Data Privacy Regulations", 2026 Huawei 2012 Labs Squirrel Seminar, 2026, Online; 2025 Bridging Transportation Researchers (BTR) Conference, 2025, Online; and 2025 KKHTCNN Symposium on Civil Engineering, 2025, Hong Kong, China
- [2] "A Lost Packet Recovery Technique for Robust Wireless Sensing", 7th IMT-2030 (6G) Plenary Meeting of Wireless Technology Group, 2024, Shanghai, China [\[PDF\]](#)

Professional Services

1. Society Membership:

- Computer Society: IEEE Student Membership, ACM Student Membership, AAAI Student Membership, CCF Student Membership

2. Conference Chair:

- Workshop Chair: ICISCC 2026 Workshop

3. TPC Membership:

- Computer & Communication Conferences: IEEE WCNC Workshop 2024-2026, IEEE PIMRC Workshop 2024-2025, IEEE GLOBECOM Workshop 2025, IEEE/CIC ICCS Workshop 2025

4. Technical Reviewer:

- Journals & Books: IEEE TPAMI, IEEE TMC, IEEE/ACM TON, IEEE IOTJ, IEEE OJCOMS, IEEE WCL, IEEE CL, Transportation Research Part E, Frontiers in AI, MTAP, Book Manuscript from Bentham Science
- Computer & Communication Conferences: IEEE IJCNN 2025-2027, AAAI 2026-2027, IEEE ICASSP 2024-2026, IEEE ICME 2024-2026, IEEE WCNC 2024-2026, ICLR 2025-2026, ACL ARR 2025-2026, IEEE MLSP 2025-2026, NeurIPS 2026, ICML 2026, CVPR 2026, ACM ICMR 2026, ICISCC 2026, IEEE PIMRC 2024-2025, IEEE AVSS 2025, IEEE GLOBECOM 2025, IEEE/CIC ICCS 2025, IET IRC 2025, IEEE SMC 2023
- Transportation Conferences: HKSTS 2024-2025, BTR 2025

Teaching Activities

1. Teaching Assistant:

- HKUST: CIVL 4640 Introduction to Smart City Economics (Undergraduate, Spring 2026)

2. Interview:

- HKUST: JUPAS 2025

Skills & Interests

1. Programming Skills:

- Proficient in: Python, PyTorch, C/C++ (CCF-CSP:320, Top 0.8%)
- Familiar with: MySQL, Git, Linux, ESP32
- Knowledgeable in: TensorFlow, Matlab, Java, Web Scraping, QT

2. Language:

- English (IELTS:6.5, CET-4:605, CET-6: 561)
- Chinese (mother tongue)

3. Interests:

- Proficient in: Electric Guitar, Acoustic Guitar, Keyboard
- Familiar with: Songwriting, Extreme Vocals, Electric Bass, Piano, Hulusi, Ukulele, Music Theory
- Knowledgeable in: Drums, Harmonica